

COMIC BOOK

Shaitan Issue #1

★★★★☆ | Created by Vivek Goel, the story is about a hidden legend on a desolate island called Astola in Pakistan. A sinister threat had been lying out of sight on the island until a group of marines discover it. Through the course of the comics, we'll get to know what kind of a Shaitan lies within that island or rather who is this Shaitan. It starts off by setting up a mysteriously discovered location which might kick off a chain of events leading to the end of the world. Gaurav Shrivastav is already known for impressive artwork from the Aghori series and his talent is clearly visible in all the panels. The gore is reminiscent of Aghori and if you've read the series, you will be able to identify the similarity. Colouring is brilliant and we loved how



the red and yellow colours were used for contrast in the final panels. We do hope Prasad Patnaik has done more of these in the other issues.

We liked how writer Anirudh Singh didn't try to reveal too much about the lore behind the temple or the visions.

The short teasers of a bigger story certainly add to increase the interest of the readers to pursue the rest of the story. Flashbacks or visions have always been an interesting method of introducing more layers to the ongoing story. The first issue plays around with this concept by actively putting one of the characters in charge of carrying the story. Therefore, it's safe to assume that they might play an important role in the upcoming issues or even the entire series.

The introduction of the characters through dialogues and conflict takes up almost half of the issue. If their story is discontinued in the next issue, it would be a wasted effort. We think that the trash talks in the first few panels could have been better. They feel forced and unnatural. It seems like they were used just for the sake of accommodating a specific set of slangs. Apart from that, we liked everything and are definitely looking forward to reviewing the next issue soon. Watch this space to know more about how we feel about the rest of the Shaitan series.

MOVIE

The Predator

★★★★☆ | The Yautja or as we call them, "Predators" are a race of extraterrestrial warriors for whom 'hunting' is akin to religion. They have been unbeaten so far but now, they have finally met their match in the form of the despot Hollywood executive. In order to make the movie more appealing to the millennial crowd, the studio decided to mess with the action-movie formula by adding a dash of asinine humour, putting a diversity hire as the main protagonist and by completely disrespecting the canon developed around the Predator universe. What we get at the end of this franchise-crushing millennial-appeasing visually-lobotomising process is a movie that's definitely not worthy of carrying the word Predator in its name.

For starters, let's take the not-so-funny humour that's prevalent across



the movie, it's so bad and out of place that you start second guessing Keegan-Michael Key's comedic skills. Then we see the Predators indulging in *SPOILER* performance-enhancing mutagens. For canon's sake! The Predators are extremely honour-bound, and to indulge

in bio-modifications just to get an extra edge is against the ethos of their culture. So to even have such a silly thing as the central plot is akin to committing science-fiction blasphemy.

Then there's the protagonist played by Olivia Munn. There's a reason why she hasn't been featured front and centre in movies, she can't act, at all. One minute she's trying to get away from the Predator and the next minute she's out chasing the 8-foot seasoned-hunter that just massacred an entire room full of armed guards and scientists with little effort. In either case, her expressions and body language are the same. Even if the studio wanted to put a female lead, they could have gone with Sanaa Lathan, the guide from AvP who was a much better fit for the Predator movies. She even fought the predator-queen in AvP alongside a youngblood. It's a pity she only did the one movie. The Predator was probably the one movie where director Shane Black had a lot more leeway as a director ... and he butchered it. Completely.